

ANSHUL SAMAR, 13

Santa Clara, USA

COMPANY: Elementeo. Developed a chemistry-based card game so that students learn while having fun.

HOW HE'LL SPEND HIS FIRST MILLION: Start a seed fund to help young entrepreneurs

CAN'T DO WITHOUT: Meditation

GAURAWA KUMAR

"Do I think I'm smart? Not really. I just had an idea and it's really how it played out."

TEENTREPRENEUR

Aggressive and supremely confident, these teenagers are stunning the world of business and venture capital

■ By Nandini Vaish

On May 18, Anshul Samar, CEO of Elementeo, clad in a white lab coat, found himself addressing a room teeming with 4,000 executives. He'd been invited to The Indus Entrepreneurs (TIE) conference—Tiecon 2007—in Santa Clara, USA. Sitting in the front row were the likes of Meg Whitman, president & CEO, eBay; Vinod Khosla, founder, Khosla Ventures; Ravi Ventakesan, chairman,

Microsoft India and Tim O'Reilly, Web 2.0 thinker. They were all ears as Samar, a 13-year-old entrepreneur and student of Sam H. Lawson Middle School in Cupertino, Santa Clara, spoke. Attendees agreed that there couldn't have been a better brand ambassador than Samar for the conference: He was "The New Face of Entrepreneurship". Samar's board-game is a mixture of chess, battlefield and playing cards. So, pawns are replaced with cards; each card stands for an element—a metal, a gas or a com-

pound. "We inject fun into education," declares Samar, his statement tinged with the American twang. "Textbooks are boring and kids would rather spend their time battling enemies and blowing things up with bombs," he adds.

Meet the 'teent entrepreneurs'—that's entrepreneurs in their teens. They are young, aggressive and supremely confident. They may not be able to hold a driver's licence but they are successfully juggling classrooms and boardrooms. They will never leave home without their iPods, laptops and Blackberrys, which are like their extra limbs. But importantly, they are not